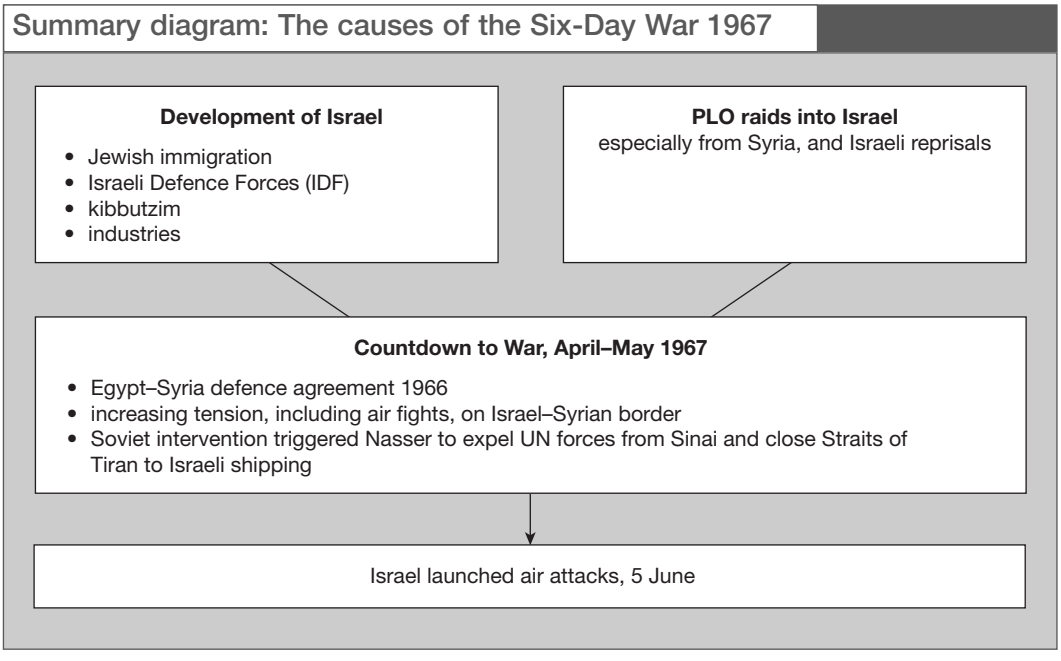
On 31 May, a second Israeli delegation went to Washington. They wanted the US government to take action to open the Straits of Tiran. The Americans suggested that Israel should take action, on its own, to open the Straits. This was taken as a sign to go ahead and take military action.

Just after dawn on Monday 5 June, the Israeli air force took off. It attacked the Arab planes on the ground: within four hours the Israelis had destroyed the air forces of Egypt, Syria and Jordan. The war was to last six days but the Israelis had virtually won on the first day. They had complete control of the skies.



4 | The Six-Day War and its Results

The fighting on three fronts, June 1967

The main facts of the fighting are presented in Table 3.1 on page 51.

The results of the Six-Day War

Key question
What were the results of the Six-Day War?

Six-Day War: 5–10 June 1967
Key date

Israeli triumph

The Israelis won a spectacular military victory and were now the dominant power in the Middle East. The Arabs had lost 15,000 men while the Israelis had lost fewer than a thousand. The Arabs had larger armies but their air forces were destroyed. The Arabs had modern Soviet missiles and other weapons but the Israelis had French fighter planes and tanks. The Israelis also had the most advanced US electronic equipment, which enabled them to intercept Arab communications, and they were highly skilled and well trained. Above all, the Israelis believed they were fighting for their nation's survival.